

OIL & GAS

A LEAP OF FAITH



54 |

► **THINK OIL AND GAS** and think green. If that is hard to grasp, it's what large companies in the sector are working towards. Take Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL), for instance. The oil-to-telecom-to-retail behemoth mentions the word green as many as 133 times in its 2023 annual report. In fact, the company makes it clear that it "is committed to maximise integration and produce high-value chemicals and green materials for the growing Indian market".

The company has already announced a massive \$10-billion investment in new energy. "A switch to cleaner energy sources is key to our decarbonisation strategy and we are making significant strides in establishing a world-class solar energy value chain. We are also progressing on building a green hydrogen ecosystem with a goal to provide affordable green hydrogen as a viable alternative to traditional fuels," Mukesh Ambani, RIL's Chairman and Managing Director, is quoted as saying in the report.

This transition has been an important theme in discussions at the G20 summit, with the energy transition track laying emphasis on the switch away from fossil fuels. So, it is expected that the forum will give India's green story a big fillip. "It allows larger countries with technology and capital to work with emerging markets like India. That means the transition to areas such as clean energy, with a helping hand, will take place in time," says Jigar Shah, Head of Sustainability Research at Maybank Investment Banking Group. "We have taken important steps on renewable energy with respect to efficiency or electric mobility. However, execution is critical."

This is a long journey calling for a big mindset change. "We will never get decarbonised unless carbon capture and storage become a reality. The potential is always there and [we] just need to move a lot faster to have a robust end-to-end mechanism to address fossil fuel," says Shah.

— Krishna Gopalan

UTILITIES

POWERING INDIA

► **AS THE WORLD'S** third-largest energy consumer, India aims to have 500 gigawatts (GW) of non-fossil fuel-based capacity by 2030. "G20 energy meetings foster discussions on global energy challenges and opportunities. Emphasising transnational green grids, we envision revolutionary changes in energy systems, successful achievement of climate goals, and millions of green jobs," says Praveer Sinha, CEO & MD of integrated power company Tata Power.

India has taken the lead by co-founding the International Solar Alliance with France. "Together with the G20 community, we pave the way towards a sustainable, resilient and affordable energy sector supported by green finance, green technology, and a robust supply chain," says Sinha.

In January, India launched the National Green Hydrogen Mission. "India leads by example, scaling up installed renewable energy capacity to 173 GW and championing initiatives like the hydrogen mission, rapid deployment of solar parks,



India's G20 presidency will help it get funding for its renewables play

and the implementation of the PLI scheme," says Vineet Mittal, Chairperson of Avaada Group, a green energy developer.

The G20 presidency will also help India attract global investments in the space. "While the country was unable to find a suitable financing pact under the Just Energy Transition Partnership in the past, its G20 presidency provides it an opportunity to find a better deal," says Rajashree Murkute, Senior Director at CareEdge Ratings.

— Manish Pant

